combat terrorism among other common concerns. The Indian Prime Minister, Dr. Manmohan Singh outlined four priority areas of cooperation: water, energy, food and environment. The Summit witnessed a high-level of maturity reached by the regional organization.

Fifteenth Summit: Colombo, 1–3 August 2008

The Fifteenth SAARC summit took place during 1–3 August 2008. The Heads of States or Governments reaffirmed their commitment to the principles and objectives enshrined in the SAARC Charter. The offer to host the Sixteenth SAARC Summit by the Maldives was welcomed with appreciation. The Heads of States or Governments stressed on the urgent need to develop the hydro potential, grid connectivity and gas pipelines of the regions concerned.

They also expressed satisfaction at the adoption of a SAARC Declaration on Climate Change for the United Nations Framework Convention on Climate Change (UNFCCC) by the Twenty-ninth Session of the Council of Ministers. The Heads of States and Governments impressed the need for even more expeditious and close regional cooperation in information and communication technology. The Heads of States and Governments emphasized their commitment to implement SAFTA in letter and in spirit, thereby enabling SAARC to contribute to the dynamic process of Asia's emergence as the powerhouse of the world. Recognizing the need to continue to address the major barriers hindering effective trade liberalization in the region, which include sensitive lists of items and Non-Trade Barriers (NTBs), they reiterated their commitment to strengthen the legal regime against terrorism, including their resolve to implement all international conventions relating to combating terrorism to which member states are parties, as well as the SAARC Regional Convention on Suppression of Terrorism and the Additional Protocol to the SAARC Regional Convention on the Suppression of Terrorism.

At the Summit, one of the major points of discussion was the global food crisis, by which they acknowledged the need to forge greater cooperation with the international community to ensure food availability and nutrition security.[22]